

SOLICITATION/CONTRACT/ORDER FOR COMMERCIAL ITEMS OFFEROR TO COMPLETE BLOCKS 12, 17, 23, 24, & 30				1. REQUISITION NUMBER 1170103		PAGE OF 1 16																			
2. CONTRACT NO.		3. AWARD/ EFFECTIVE DATE	4. ORDER NUMBER		5. SOLICITATION NUMBER 1232SA26Q0596		6. SOLICITATION ISSUE DATE 05/05/2026																		
7. FOR SOLICITATION INFORMATION CALL:		a. NAME RICHARD HAWTHORNE			b. TELEPHONE NUMBER (No collect calls) 6626865296		8. OFFER DUE DATE/LOCAL TIME 05/18/2026 1700 ET																		
9. ISSUED BY USDA ARS ACQUISITION AND PROPERTY D 5601 SUNNYSIDE AVENUE RM 3-2102 BELTSVILLE MD 20705				CODE ARS-1232SA 10. THIS ACQUISITION IS ☒ SMALL BUSINESS ☐ HUBZONE SMALL BUSINESS ☐ SERVICE-DISABLED VETERAN-OWNED SMALL BUSINESS (SDVOSB) ☐ UNRESTRICTED OR ☐ WOMEN-OWNED SMALL BUSINESS (WOSB) ☐ ECONOMICALLY DISADVANTAGED WOMEN-OWNED SMALL BUSINESS (EDWOSB) ☐ 8(A) ☒ SET ASIDE: 100.00 % FOR: NORTH AMERICAN INDUSTRY CLASSIFICATION STANDARD (NAICS): 561730 SIZE STANDARD: \$9.5																					
11. DELIVERY FOR FREE ON BOARD (FOB) DESTINATION UNLESS BLOCK IS MARKED ☒ SEE SCHEDULE		12. DISCOUNT TERMS		13a. THIS CONTRACT IS A RATED ORDER UNDER THE DEFENSE PRIORITIES AND ALLOCATIONS SYSTEM - DPAS (15 CFR 700) ☐		13b. RATING 14. METHOD OF SOLICITATION ☒ REQUEST FOR QUOTE (RFQ) ☐ INVITATION FOR BID (IFB) ☐ REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP)																			
15. DELIVER TO USDA/ARS Insect Behavior and Biocon 6383 MAHAN DRIVE TALLAHASSEE FL 32308				CODE ARS-124320 16. ADMINISTERED BY USDA ARS ACQUISITION AND PROPERTY D 5601 SUNNYSIDE AVENUE RM 3-2102 BELTSVILLE MD 20705																					
17a. CONTRACTOR/ OFFEROR		CODE	FACILITY CODE	18a. PAYMENT WILL BE MADE BY																					
				CODE ARS-1232SA																					
TELEPHONE NO.				18b. SUBMIT INVOICES TO ADDRESS SHOWN IN BLOCK 18a UNLESS BLOCK BELOW IS CHECKED ☐ SEE ADDENDUM																					
☐ 17b. CHECK IF REMITTANCE IS DIFFERENT AND PUT SUCH ADDRESS IN OFFER																									
<table border="1" style="width:100%; border-collapse: collapse;"> <thead> <tr> <th style="width:10%;">19. ITEM NO.</th> <th style="width:50%;">20. SCHEDULE OF SUPPLIES/SERVICES</th> <th style="width:10%;">21. QUANTITY</th> <th style="width:5%;">22. UNIT</th> <th style="width:15%;">23. UNIT PRICE</th> <th style="width:10%;">24. AMOUNT</th> </tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>0001</td> <td>Delivery: 05/24/2027 Base Year: Grounds Maintenance Period of Performance: 05/25/2026 to 05/24/2027</td> <td></td> <td></td> <td></td> <td></td> </tr> <tr> <td>1001</td> <td>Option Year 1: Grounds Maintenance (Option Line Item) 05/25/2027 Period of Performance: 05/25/2027 to 05/24/2028 Continued ... (Use Reverse and/or Attach Additional Sheets as Necessary)</td> <td></td> <td></td> <td></td> <td></td> </tr> </tbody> </table>								19. ITEM NO.	20. SCHEDULE OF SUPPLIES/SERVICES	21. QUANTITY	22. UNIT	23. UNIT PRICE	24. AMOUNT	0001	Delivery: 05/24/2027 Base Year: Grounds Maintenance Period of Performance: 05/25/2026 to 05/24/2027					1001	Option Year 1: Grounds Maintenance (Option Line Item) 05/25/2027 Period of Performance: 05/25/2027 to 05/24/2028 Continued ... (Use Reverse and/or Attach Additional Sheets as Necessary)				
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25. ACCOUNTING AND APPROPRIATION DATA					26. TOTAL AWARD AMOUNT (For Government Use Only)																				
☒ 27a. SOLICITATION INCORPORATES BY REFERENCE (FEDERAL ACQUISITION REGULATION) FAR 52.212-1, 52.212-4. FAR 52.212-3 AND 52.212-5 ARE ATTACHED. ADDENDA					☒ ARE ☐ ARE NOT ATTACHED.																				
☐ 27b. CONTRACT/PURCHASE ORDER INCORPORATES BY REFERENCE FAR 52.212-4. FAR 52.212-5 IS ATTACHED. ADDENDA					☐ ARE ☐ ARE NOT ATTACHED.																				
☐ 28. CONTRACTOR IS REQUIRED TO SIGN THIS DOCUMENT AND RETURN COPIES TO ISSUING OFFICE. CONTRACTOR AGREES TO FURNISH AND DELIVER ALL ITEMS SET FORTH OR OTHERWISE IDENTIFIED ABOVE AND ON ANY ADDITIONAL SHEETS SUBJECT TO THE TERMS AND CONDITIONS SPECIFIED.				☐ 29. AWARD OF CONTRACT: REFERENCE _____ OFFER DATED _____. YOUR OFFER ON SOLICITATION (BLOCK 5), INCLUDING ANY ADDITIONS OR CHANGES WHICH ARE SET FORTH HEREIN, IS ACCEPTED AS TO ITEMS:																					
30a. SIGNATURE OF OFFEROR/CONTRACTOR				31a. UNITED STATES OF AMERICA (SIGNATURE OF CONTRACTING OFFICER)																					
30b. NAME AND TITLE OF SIGNER (Type or print)		30c. DATE SIGNED		31b. NAME OF CONTRACTING OFFICER (Type or print)		31c. DATE SIGNED																			
				FRANK C. PALMER																					

19. ITEM NO.	20. SCHEDULE OF SUPPLIES/SERVICES	21. QUANTITY	22. UNIT	23. UNIT PRICE	24. AMOUNT
2001	Option Year 2: Grounds Maintenance (Option Line Item) 05/28/2028 Period of Performance: 05/25/2028 to 05/24/2029				
3001	Option Year 3: Grounds Maintenance (Option Line Item) 05/28/2029 Period of Performance: 05/25/2029 to 05/24/2030				
4001	Option Year 4: Grounds Maintenance (Option Line Item) 05/25/2030 Period of Performance: 05/25/2030 to 05/24/2031				

32a. QUANTITY IN COLUMN 21 HAS BEEN

☐ RECEIVED ☐ INSPECTED ☐ ACCEPTED, AND CONFORMS TO THE CONTRACT, EXCEPT AS NOTED: _____

32b. SIGNATURE OF AUTHORIZED GOVERNMENT REPRESENTATIVE		32c. DATE	32d. PRINTED NAME AND TITLE OF AUTHORIZED GOVERNMENT REPRESENTATIVE	
32e. MAILING ADDRESS OF AUTHORIZED GOVERNMENT REPRESENTATIVE			32f. TELEPHONE NUMBER OF AUTHORIZED GOVERNMENT REPRESENTATIVE	
			32g. E-MAIL OF AUTHORIZED GOVERNMENT REPRESENTATIVE	
33. SHIP NUMBER	34. VOUCHER NUMBER	35. AMOUNT VERIFIED CORRECT FOR	36. PAYMENT	37. CHECK NUMBER
☐ PARTIAL ☐ FINAL			☐ COMPLETE ☐ PARTIAL ☐ FINAL	
38. S/R ACCOUNT NUMBER	39. S/R VOUCHER NUMBER	40. PAID BY		
41a. I CERTIFY THIS ACCOUNT IS CORRECT AND PROPER FOR PAYMENT			42a. RECEIVED BY (<i>Print</i>)	
41b. SIGNATURE AND TITLE OF CERTIFYING OFFICER		41c. DATE	42b. RECEIVED AT (<i>Location</i>)	
			42c. DATE REC'D (YY/MM/DD)	42d. TOTAL CONTAINERS

Grounds Maintenance 1232SA26Q0596

Description -

This is a combined synopsis/solicitation for commercial items prepared in accordance with the format in FAR Part 12. This announcement constitutes the only solicitation. Quotations are being requested and a separate written solicitation will not be issued.

Solicitation number 1232SA26Q0596 is issued as a Request for Quotation (RFQ) for Grounds Maintenance.

This acquisition is set-aside for small business concerns. The applicable North American Industry Classification Standard Code is 561730. The small business size standard is \$9.5M. This acquisition is a Total Small Business Set-Aside. All responsible sources may submit a quotation which will be considered by the agency.

The USDA, ARS, in Tallahassee, FL has a new requirement for grounds maintenance.

Service Required:

- Mowing of grass
- Trim shrubs as needed
- Weeding of internal areas between walkways
- Edging of parking lot and walkway
- Sweeping and cleaning all walkways, drives, and parking lot
- Removal of all lawn maintenance debris from premises
- All applicable health and safety laws and regulations must be complied with

The intent is to award a contract of a Base Year plus 4 Option Years. Estimated dates:

Base Year – 5-25-26 to 5-24-27

Option Year 1 – 5-25-27 to 5-24-28

Option Year 2 – 5-25-28 to 5-24-29

Option Year 3 – 5-25-29 to 5-24-30

Option Year 4 – 5-25-30 to 5-24-31

Award Type

The Government intends to make one award from this solicitation. Therefore, to be considered responsive, contractors must submit pricing for all items.

Evaluation and Basis for Award

The provision at FAR 52.212-2, Evaluation—Commercial Products and Commercial Services is not applicable to this solicitation. In lieu of this provision, quotes will be evaluated in accordance with FAR 12.203 based on the criteria listed below. Award will be made to the offeror representing the best value to the Government.

The Government will conduct a comparative evaluation of quotes to select the Contractor that is best suited to fulfill the requirement. The evaluation factors are: Price and Technical Capability. The Government reserves the right to select a quote that represents a superior technical solution, even if it is not the lowest priced.

Submission Requirements:

To be considered, provide a quote on company letterhead including:

- **Vendor Details:** SAM.gov UEI Number.

Grounds Maintenance
1232SA26Q0596

- **Technical Documentation:** Provide a brief Capability Statement listing the equipment and number of personnel to be used and a "meets/does not meet" statement confirming your ability to fulfill all tasks and frequencies in the SOW.
- **Self-Performance/Subcontracting:** State whether work will be self-performed or subcontracted; if subcontracting, provide the subcontractor's company name, UEI number, and a signed Letter of Commitment from the subcontractor confirming they have reviewed the SOW and are prepared to perform the services at the proposed price.
- **Pricing:** The total aggregate price for the Base Year and all Option Years (complete section 5.0 of the SOW).
- **Timeline:** Estimated lead time/delivery date.
- **Validity:** Quote must be valid for at least 60 days.

Offerors shall identify where the offered item meets or does not meet each of the Government's functional and performance minimum specifications listed herein.

Please ensure all email correspondence includes the solicitation number in the subject line. Emails without the RFQ number in the subject line may not be seen, read, and /or reviewed and therefore disqualified from consideration.

QUESTIONS REGARDING THIS RFQ ARE DUE TO RICHARD HAWTHORNE at Richard.hawthorne@usda.gov, NO LATER THAN 1:00 p. m. ET, May 14th, 2026. Questions will only be accepted via email and WILL NOT be answered if received after this date/time.

QUOTES REGARDING THIS RFQ ARE DUE TO RICHARD HAWTHORNE at Richard.hawthorne@usda.gov , NO LATER THAN 5:00 p. m. ET, May 18th, 2026.

Performance Location:

USDA-ARS-CENTER FOR BIOLOGICAL CONTROL
6383 Mahan Drive
Tallahassee, Florida 32308

Site Visit Information

- **Date/Time:** 10am, ET, Tuesday May 12th, 2026
- **Meeting Location:** 6383 Mahan Drive, Tallahassee, Florida 32308 at the East end of the parking lot in front of the USDA sign.
- **POC for Access:** Alex Gaffke, 352-283-7712, alexander.gaffke@usda.gov
- **Inquiries:** The POC is for site visit coordination and physical access only. The POC is not authorized to discuss the RFQ, technical specifications, or contract terms. All formal inquiries and Requests for Information (RFIs) must be submitted in writing to the Contract Specialist at Richard.hawthorne@usda.gov. Any information obtained from unauthorized sources is unofficial and non-binding. Bidders who attempt to bypass formal RFI procedures or seek an unfair competitive advantage through unauthorized technical contact may have their proposals found non-responsive.

GROUNDS MAINTENANCE SERVICES
USDA-ARS-CENTER FOR BIOLOGICAL CONTROL
6383 Mahan Drive
Tallahassee, Florida 32308

The U.S. Department of Agriculture, Agricultural Research Service, requires maintenance of grounds at the above address.

The amount of services visits will be as follows.

October to March – Monthly services

April to September – Weekly services

All grounds will be kept well maintained at all times of seasons.

- Payments will be made on a monthly basis in arrears.

Service Required:

- Mowing of grass
- Trim shrubs as needed
- Weeding of internal areas between walkways
- Edging of parking lot and walkway
- Sweeping and cleaning all walkways, drives, and parking lot
- Removal of all lawn maintenance debris from premises
- All applicable health and safety laws and regulations must be complied with

Roughly 0.3 acres of property that requires maintenance.

The contractor will furnish all personnel, supplies and equipment to perform service.

Price List

CLIN	Period	Service Description	Annual Firm-Fixed Price
0001	Base	Grounds Maintenance	
1001	Option Year 1	Grounds Maintenance	
2001	Option Year 2	Grounds Maintenance	
3001	Option Year 3	Grounds Maintenance	
4001	Option Year 4	Grounds Maintenance	
		Total price (Base + 4 option years)	

Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) and United States Department of Agriculture Acquisition Regulation (AGAR) Clauses and Provisions

The clauses and provisions contained herein are applicable to any order awarded as a result of this solicitation. The terms and conditions set forth herein supersede all other terms and conditions. Acceptance of the order in accordance with (IAW) FAR 12.201-1(b)(2) constitutes acceptance of all terms and conditions contained herein.

As part of the Revolutionary FAR Overhaul (RFO), system updates may lag policy updates. The System for Award Management (SAM) may continue to require entities to complete representations based on provisions that are not included in this solicitation. Contracting officers will rely on representations from offers based on provisions in the solicitation. Entities are not required to, nor are they able to, update their entity registration to remove these representations in SAM.

52.252-2 Clauses Incorporated by Reference

Feb 1998

This solicitation incorporates one or more clauses by reference, with the same force and effect as if they were given in full text. Upon request, the Contracting Officer will make their full text available. Also the full text of the clause may be accessed electronically at Internet address <https://www.acquisition.gov/far-overhaul/far-part-deviation-guide/far-overhaul-part-52>

- 52.212-4 Terms and Conditions—Commercial Products and Commercial Services (Nov 2025)
 - ☐ Alternate I (Nov 2025) of 52.212-4
- 52.203-17 Contractor Employee Whistleblower Rights (Nov 2023)
- 52.203-19 Prohibition on Requiring Certain Internal Confidentiality Agreements or Statements (Jan 2017)
- 52.222-50 Combating Trafficking in Persons (Nov 2025)
 - ☐ Alternate I (Nov 2025) of 52.222-50
- 52.222-90 Addressing DEI Discrimination by Federal Contractors (Apr 2026)
- 52.226-8 Encouraging Contractor Policies to Ban Text Messaging While Driving (May 2024)
- 52.232-39 Unenforceability of Unauthorized Obligations (Jun 2013)
- 52.232-40 Providing Accelerated Payments to Small Business Subcontractors (Mar 2023)
- 52.233-3 Protest After Award (Sep 2025)
- 52.233-4 Applicable Law for Breach of Contract Claim (Sep 2025)
- 52.240-91 Security Prohibitions and Exclusions (Nov 2025)
 - ☐ Alternate I (Nov 2025) of 52.240-91
- 52.244-6 Subcontracts for Commercial Products and Commercial Services (Nov 2025)

The following clauses are applicable if checked:

- ☒ 52.204-13 System for Award Management—Maintenance (Nov 2025)
- ☒ 52.209-6 Protecting the Government's Interest When Subcontracting with Contractors Debarred, Suspended, or Proposed for Debarment (Sep 2025)
- ☒ 52.209-10 Prohibition on Contracting with Inverted Domestic Corporations (Sep 2025)
- ☒ 52.219-6 Notice of Total Small Business Aside (Nov 2025)

- ☐ Alternate I (Mar 2020).
- ☒ 52.222-3 Convict Labor (June 2003)
- ☒ 52.222-19 Child Labor—Cooperation with Authorities and Remedies (Nov 2025)
- ☒ 52.222-36 Equal Opportunity for Workers with Disabilities (Nov 2025)
- ☐ Alternate I (Jul 2014) of 52.222-36
- ☒ 52.222-41 Service Contract Labor Standards (Aug 2018)
- ☒ 52.222-42 Statement of Equivalent Rates for Federal Hires (May 2014)

This Statement is for Information Only:

It is not a Wage Determination

Employee Class	Monetary Wage -- Fringe Benefits
Gardener (WG-06)	\$22.84 -- 36.25%

- ☒ 52.222-62 Paid Sick Leave Under Executive Order 13706 (Jan 2022)
- ☒ 52.223-23 Sustainable Products and Services
- ☒ 52.232-33 Payment by Electronic Funds Transfer— System for Award Management (Oct 2018)

Other Applicable Clauses

- 52.217-9 Option to Extend the Term of the Contract (Mar 2000)
- (a) 30 Calendar days prior to contract expiration and 30 days
- (c) five years and 6 months.

AGAR Clauses

- 452.203-71 Anti-Discrimination and Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) Compliance (Dec 2025)

(a) By entering into this contract, the Contractor certifies that:

- (1) It is compliant with all applicable Federal anti-discrimination laws and the Equal Protection principles of the U.S. Constitution, and it will remain compliant for the duration of the contract.
- (2) Neither it nor any subcontractor or teaming partner operates or funds any program, policy, or initiative that promotes DEI in a manner that violates any applicable Federal anti-discrimination laws, including but not limited to Title VI and VII of the Civil Rights Act of 1964, or the Equal Protection principles of the U.S. Constitution, and the Contractor and any subcontractor or teaming partner will not do so for the duration of the contract.

(b) If the Contractor participates in, facilitates, or funds programs that implicate Title VI of the Civil Rights Act of 1964 or Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972, as amended, including but not

limited to grants to or for schools, colleges, universities, 4-H programs, non-governmental organization (NGO) programs, sports programs, and education-related grants to prisons or other detention facilities, the Contractor certifies that it will remain compliant with those laws, including the requirements set forth in Executive Order 14168, Defending Women from Gender Ideology Extremism and Restoring Biological Truth to the Federal Government, and Executive Order 14173, Ending Illegal Discrimination and Restoring Merit-Based Opportunity.

(c) The Contractor affirms that the above requirements are conditions of payment that go to the essence of the contract and are therefore material terms of the contract. Payments under the contract are predicated on compliance with the above requirements, and therefore the Contractor is not eligible for funding under the contract or to retain any funding under the contract absent compliance with the above requirements.

(d) This certification reflects a change in the Government's position regarding the materiality of the foregoing requirements and therefore any prior payment of similar claims does not reflect the materiality of the foregoing requirements to this contract.

(e) Submission of a knowing false statement relating to Contractor's compliance with the above requirements and/or eligibility for the contract may subject the Contractor to liability under the False Claims Act, 31 U.S.C. § 3729, and/or criminal liability, including under 18 U.S.C. §§ 287 and 1001.

(f) The Contractor must include the provisions of this clause in all subcontract solicitations.

(g) Failure on the part of the Contractor or its subcontractors to comply with the terms of this clause may be grounds for the Contracting Officer to terminate this contract for default.
(End of Clause)

AGAR 452.203-72 Unenforceable Supplier Terms

(a) Definitions.

Supplier terms mean provisions customarily drafted by vendors of supplies or services and intended to create a binding legal obligation on the end user. The term applies:

1. Regardless of the format or style of the document. For example, supplier terms may appear in standard terms of sale or lease, Terms of Service (TOS), End User License Agreement (EULA), or another similar legal instrument or agreement, and may be presented as part of a proposal or quotation responding to a solicitation for a contract or order or otherwise become effective after the contract date.
2. Regardless of the media or delivery mechanism used. For example, supplier terms may be presented as one or more paper documents or may appear on a computer or other electronic device screen during a purchase, software installation, other product delivery, registration for a service, or another transaction.

(b) Applicability. When any supply or service acquired under this contract is subject to supplier terms, the supplier terms are deemed part of the contract only to the extent they are consistent with this clause. Supplier terms that conflict with any part of this clause, the contract, or Federal law are void and will not be considered incorporated into a contract, even if they are physically present in a contract documentation or systems. In the event of any inconsistency between supplier terms and this contract, this clause and the terms of the Government contract shall govern and supersede any supplier terms in all cases.

(c) Authorization Required. Notwithstanding any other provision, no supplier terms shall be binding on the Government unless the term is expressly authorized on the USDA Supplier Terms Authorization Form signed by the Contracting Officer, and the completed Authorization Form has been incorporated into the contract.

(d) Unenforceable Terms. Any supplier terms that impose obligations or restrictions inconsistent with applicable Federal law are unenforceable against the Government and deemed stricken from the agreement. This includes, but is not limited to, any clause that:

1. Requires the Government to pay future fees, penalties, interest, legal costs, early termination fees, cancellation fees, minimum purchase commitments, trueup payments, seatcount minimums, usage minimums, continued use charges, or any other financial obligation not expressly authorized by the contract.
2. Requires the Government to indemnify the contractor or any other entity.
3. Restricts the Government's ability to obtain similar supplies or services from another source.
4. Imposes any penalty, financial or otherwise, based on the Government's decision not to exercise an option.
5. Subjects the United States Government to the laws of any U.S. state, territory, district, municipality, or foreign nation, except where Federal law expressly permits such application.
6. Requires dispute resolution in a forum or venue other than one prescribed by applicable Federal law.
7. Establishes a period of limitations for bringing an action that differs from that provided by applicable Federal law.
8. Grants the contractor rights to use, mine, access, aggregate, analyze, or otherwise exploit Government data, usage data, or metadata.
9. Deems the Government to have accepted initial or revised terms based on silence, continued performance, or failure to object.

10. Grants the supplier the right to audit Government facilities, systems, records, or use of the product or service, except as expressly authorized by the contract and applicable Federal law.
11. Requires the Government to accept supplier security requirements, network access requirements, monitoring, penetration testing, or other technical or security measures.
12. Permits the supplier to suspend, degrade, or terminate access to products or services based on alleged nonpayment, alleged breach, automated security triggers.
13. Limits the Government's right to use, install, access, test, evaluate, or transfer the licensed product or service in any manner consistent with the contract and Federal law.
14. Requires the Government to store, process, maintain, or transmit data in a particular geographic location, or permits the supplier to transfer Government data outside the United States, except as expressly authorized by applicable Federal law.
15. Authorizes the supplier to use the Government's name, seal, trademark, logo, or any reference to the Government as an end user or customer for marketing, publicity, promotional activities, press releases, or similar purposes.
16. Incorporates by reference, or requires the Government to accept, terms or conditions imposed by any third party, subcontractor, or upstream service provider, unless such terms are expressly incorporated into the contract by bilateral modification.
17. Limits, conditions, or negates the contractor's performance obligations, service levels, or remedies through a supplier-provided service level agreement (SLA).
18. Uses Government data, usage data, metadata, prompts, content, or interactions to train, fine-tune, improve, or derive any artificial intelligence, machine learning, or automated decision-making model.
19. Subjects the Government to automated decision-making, automated risk scoring, automated content moderation, or any algorithmic process that may affect access, performance, or rights under the contract.
20. Utilizes artificial intelligence or algorithmic tools that produce decisions, recommendations, or outputs affecting contract performance without providing transparency, explainability, auditability, and bias-mitigation consistent with applicable Federal law and policy.
21. Profiles, tracks, or analyzes Government user behavior, preferences, communications, or interactions for personalization, marketing, or algorithmic optimization purposes.

(e) Non-binding Actions. Neither the Government nor any Government authorized end user is deemed to have consented to any term, condition, or clause by virtue of its inclusion in the supplier

agreement or through the use of clickwrap, browsewrap, “I agree” mechanisms, or similar means. Execution of such mechanisms does not bind the Government or its authorized end users to any unenforceable terms.

(f) End user. The supplier agreement shall bind the ordering activity as the end user to the extent it does not conflict with the terms of this clause, but it shall not bind or impose personal liability on any Government employee or any person acting on behalf of the Government in their personal capacity.

(g) Law and disputes. The supplier agreement is governed by Federal law.

(h) Statutory exception. This clause does not apply to indemnification or any other payment by the Government that is expressly authorized by statute and specifically authorized under applicable agency regulations and procedures.

(i) Continued performance. The supplier or licensor shall not unilaterally revoke, terminate, or suspend any rights granted to the Government except as allowed by the contract. If the supplier or licensor believes the ordering activity to be in breach of the supplier agreement, it shall pursue its rights under the Contract Disputes Act or other applicable Federal statute while proceeding diligently with performance, pending final resolution of any dispute in accordance with the Disputes Clause at FAR 52.212-4(d) or FAR 52.233-1, as applicable.

(j) Arbitration. Binding arbitration shall not be used unless specifically authorized by agency guidance.

(k) Equitable or injunctive relief. Equitable or injunctive relief, including the award of attorney fees, costs, or interest, may be awarded against the United States Government only when explicitly provided by statute (e.g., the Prompt Payment Act or the Equal Access to Justice Act).

(l) Revisions to supplier agreements. Any revisions to the supplier agreement must be incorporated into the contract using a bilateral modification. Unilateral revisions are not binding on the Government.

(m) No automatic renewals. If any license or service tied to periodic payment is provided under the supplier agreement (e.g., annual software maintenance or annual lease term), such license or service shall not renew automatically upon expiration of its current term without prior express written consent from an authorized Government representative.

(n) Indemnification. Any clause of the supplier agreement requiring the supplier or licensor to defend or indemnify the end user is amended to provide that the U.S. Department of Justice has the sole right to represent the United States in any such action, in accordance with 28 U.S.C. 516.

(o) Taxes or surcharges. Any taxes or surcharges which the supplier or licensor seeks to pass along to the Government as end user will be governed by the terms of the associated Government contract or order and must be submitted to the Contracting Officer for a determination of applicability prior to invoicing unless specifically agreed otherwise.

(p) Non-assignment. The supplier agreement may not be assigned, nor may any rights or obligations thereunder be delegated, without the Government's prior approval, except as expressly permitted by FAR 52.212-4(b) or FAR 52.232-23, as applicable.

(q) Confidential information. If the supplier agreement includes a confidentiality clause, such clause is amended to state that neither the agreement nor the contract price list, as applicable, shall be deemed "confidential information." Issues regarding release of "unit pricing" will be resolved consistent with the Freedom of Information Act. Notwithstanding anything in the supplier agreement to the contrary, the Government may retain any confidential information as required by law, regulation, or its internal document retention procedures for legal, regulatory, or compliance purposes; provided, however, that all such retained confidential information will continue to be subject to the confidentiality obligations of the supplier agreement.

(r) Conflict with Federal law. If any other language, provision, or clause of the supplier agreement conflicts or is inconsistent with Federal law or the terms and conditions of this contract, such language, provisions, or clauses will be considered null and void and will not be binding on the United States Government.

(End of Clause)

452.204-70 Modification for Contract Closeout (Nov 2025)

(a) If unliquidated funds in the amount of \$1000 or less remain on the contract, the Contracting Officer (Contracting Officer) shall issue a unilateral modification for deobligation. The contractor will receive a copy of the modification but will not be required to provide a signature. The Contracting Officer shall immediately proceed with contract closeout upon completion of the period of performance, receipt and acceptance of supplies or services, and final payment.

(b) Upon contract closeout for contracts utilizing SAP: if unliquidated funds of more than \$1000 remain on the contract, the Contracting Officer shall issue a bilateral modification for deobligation. The contractor will receive a copy of the modification and will be required to provide a signature. (The Contracting Officer may also request a "Contractor Release of Claims" be completed by the contractor, although not required for contracts and orders using SAP.) If the bilateral modification and Release of Claims are not returned to the Contracting Officer within 60 days, the Contracting Officer shall release the modification as unilateral and proceed with contract close-out upon completion of the period of performance, receipt and acceptance of supplies or services, and final payment.

(c) Upon contract closeout for contracts utilizing anything other than cost reimbursement, if unliquidated funds of more than \$1000 remain on the contract, the Contracting Officer shall issue a bilateral modification for deobligation. The contractor will receive a copy of the modification and a "Contractor Release of Claims" and will be required to provide a signature on both forms. If the bilateral modification and Release of Claims are not returned to the Contracting Officer within 120 days, the Contracting Officer shall release the modification as unilateral and proceed with contract closeout upon completion of the period of performance, receipt and acceptance of supplies or services, and final payment.

(End of Clause)

(END OF CLAUSES)

52.252-1 Solicitation Provisions Incorporated by Reference

Feb 1998

This solicitation incorporates one or more solicitation provisions by reference, with the same force and effect as if they were given in full text. Upon request, the Contracting Officer will make their full text available. The offeror is cautioned that the listed provisions may include blocks that must be completed by the offeror and submitted with its quotation or offer. In lieu of submitting the full text of those provisions, the offeror may identify the provision by paragraph identifier and provide the appropriate information with its quotation or offer. Also, the full text of a solicitation provision may be accessed electronically at this/these address(es): <https://www.acquisition.gov/far-overhaul/far-part-deviation-guide/far-overhaul-part-52>

- 52.212-1 Instructions to Offerors - Commercial Products and Commercial Services (Nov 2025)
- 52.203-18 Prohibition on Contracting with Entities that Require Certain Internal Confidentiality Agreements or Statements-Representation (Jan 2017)
- 52.209-2 Prohibition on Contracting with Inverted Domestic Corporations - Representation (Sep 2025)
- 52.209-11 Representation by Corporations Regarding Delinquent Tax Liability or a Felony Conviction under any Federal Law (Sep 2025)
- 52.240-90 Security Prohibitions and Exclusions Representations and Certifications (Nov 2025)

The following provisions are applicable if checked:

- ☒ 52.204-7 System for Award Management—Registration (Nov 2025)
 - ☐ Alternate I (Nov 2025) to 52.204-7

Other Applicable FAR Provisions

- 52.217-5 Evaluation of Options (Nov 2025)

AGAR Provisions

- 452.203-70 Anti-Discrimination and Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) Certification (Dec 2025)

(a) By submission of its offer, the offeror certifies that:

- (3) It is compliant with all applicable Federal anti-discrimination laws and the Equal Protection principles of the U.S. Constitution.
- (4) Neither it nor any proposed subcontractor or teaming partner operates or funds any program, policy, or initiative that promotes DEI in a manner that violates any applicable Federal anti-discrimination laws, including but not limited to Title VI and VII of the Civil Rights Act of 1964, or the Equal Protection principles of the U.S. Constitution.

(b) If the offeror participates in, facilitates, or funds programs that implicate Title VI of the Civil Rights Act of 1964 or Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972, as amended, including but not limited to grants to or for schools, colleges, universities, 4-H programs, non-governmental organization (NGO) programs, sports programs, and education-related grants to prisons or other detention facilities, by submission of its offer, the offeror certifies that it is compliant with those laws, including the requirements set forth in Executive Order 14168, Defending Women from Gender Ideology Extremism and Restoring Biological Truth to the Federal Government, and Executive Order 14173, Ending Illegal Discrimination and Restoring Merit-Based Opportunity.

(c) The offeror affirms that the above requirements are conditions of payment that go to the essence of the contract and are therefore material terms of the contract. Payments under the contract are predicated on compliance with the above requirements, and therefore the offeror will not be eligible for funding under the contract or to retain any funding under the contract absent compliance with the above requirements.

(d) This certification reflects a change in the Government's position regarding the materiality of the foregoing requirements and therefore any prior payment of similar claims does not reflect the materiality of the foregoing requirements to this contract.

(e) Submission of a knowing false statement relating to offeror's compliance with the above requirements and/or eligibility for the contract may subject the offeror to liability under the False Claims Act, 31 U.S.C. § 3729, and/or criminal liability, including under 18 U.S.C. §§ 287 and 1001.

(f) Failure on the part of the offeror or its subcontractors to comply with the terms of this clause may be grounds for the Contracting Officer to terminate the contract for default.
(End of Provision)

(END OF PROVISIONS)

NOTICE FOR FILING AGENCY PROTESTS

United States Department of Agriculture (USDA) Ombudsman Program

The USDA is committed to issuing solicitations and awarding contracts in a fair and prompt manner. The Ombudsman Program for Agency Protests (OPAP) was established to address protest issues within the agency, providing an alternative to costly and time-consuming litigation. Operating independently, OPAP offers relief comparable to that granted by the Government Accountability Office (GAO). Interested parties are encouraged to resolve concerns through USDA's internal Alternative Dispute Resolution (ADR) process before pursuing external forums such as the GAO. Concerns may be addressed informally or through a formal agency protest filed with either the Contracting Officer or the Ombudsman.

Informal Forum with the Ombudsman

1. **Initial Point of Contact:** Interested parties who believe a specific USDA procurement is unfair or otherwise defective should first direct their concerns to the applicable Contracting Officer.

2. **Escalation:** If the Contracting Officer is unable to address their concerns, interested parties are encouraged to contact the USDA Ombudsman for Agency Protests. Under this informal process, the agency is not required to suspend contract award performance. Utilization of the informal forum does not suspend any time requirement for filing a formal protest with the agency or other forums.
3. **Required Information:** To ensure a timely response, interested parties should provide the following information to the Ombudsman: solicitation/contract number, contracting office, Contracting Officer, and solicitation closing date (if applicable).

Formal Agency Protest with the Ombudsman

1. **Effort to Resolve:** Prior to submitting a formal agency protest, protesters must first use their best efforts to resolve their concerns with the Contracting Officer through open and frank discussions.
2. **Independent Review:** If the protester's concerns remain unresolved, an Independent Review is available by the Ombudsman. The protester may file a formal agency protest with either the Contracting Officer or, alternatively, with the Ombudsman under the OPAP program. Contract awards or performance will be suspended during the protest period unless justified in writing for urgent and compelling reasons or determined in writing to be in the best interest of the Government.
3. **Resolution Timeline:** The agency's goal is to resolve protests within 35 calendar days from the date of filing.
4. **Required Information:** Protests shall include the information set forth in FAR 33.104(a)(3). Failure to submit the required information may result in a delay or dismissal of the protest.
5. **Timeliness:** Protests must be filed within the timeframes specified in FAR 33.104.
6. **Submission:** Formal protests under the OPAP program should be submitted electronically to SPE.inquiry@usda.gov and the Contracting Officer.

Election of Forum. By initiating a protest with the USDA, the protester agrees not to pursue the same matter with the Government Accountability Office (GAO) or any other external forum while the agency protest is pending. If a protest is filed externally, the agency protest will be dismissed.

IPP.gov

How to enroll in IPP

Vendors that are required to submit an invoice through IPP do not need to contact IPP to enroll. Enrollment will be initiated by the agency they are doing business with and will be completed by IPP. Once enrolled, vendors will receive two emails with an IPP login ID and a temporary password.

If you already have an IPP.gov account, but do not know your login info, please have your Tax ID Number (TIN) ready when you reach out to IPP.

What happens next?

- After an account is established, you will receive two emails. The first one will include your IPP User ID, and 12 to 24 hours later a second email will give you a 12-character password. Use the ID and password to log onto IPP. You will be asked to change the temporary password to one of your own choosing, agree to the rules for using IPP, and set up the answers to security questions. As a vendor who provides goods or services to a government agency, once logged in you will be granted access to IPP's Collector module which will allow you to view purchase orders, submit invoices, access payment information, and more.
- Please note that only one Administrator can be initially enrolled in your IPP vendor profile. The Administrator can then add additional users as necessary.
- Allow 5 to 10 business days for registration.
- All government vendors must register and continue to maintain their account data in the System for Award Management (SAM) registry and activate it annually. Please visit <http://www.SAM.gov/> for more information.

E-mail notifications of payments are sent when a payment is distributed to your bank account and will include all pertinent payment information. The IPP Customer Support Desk is available to assist users Monday through Friday (excluding bank holidays) from 8:00AM - 6:00PM ET, including answering any questions related to accessing IPP or completing the registration process. Their tollfree number is (866) 973-3131 or they can be reached at: IPPCustomerSupport@fiscal.treasury.gov